



Seychelles

Africa

Coco de mer

Nicknamed the "double coconut," the fruit of the coco de mer palm grows only in the Seychelles. The islanders eat this rare nut, or gift it to one another, but never sell it.

The seed of the coco de mer palm weighs up to 38.8 lb (17.6 kg).



Meat-eating plant

The only species of its kind that grows in the Seychelles, Perville's pitcher plant is carnivorous. Its leaves form a deadly trap for insects that fall inside.



Dazzling sands

Regularly named one of the world's most breathtaking beaches, Anse Source d'Argent has swaying palms, rocky boulders, soft sands, and clear, shallow waters.

0 200 km
0 200 miles
(approximate scale)

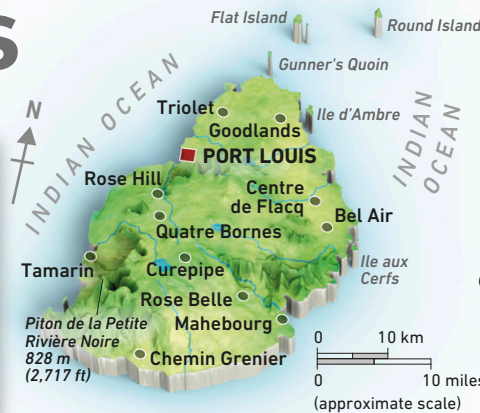


Mauritius



- 788 sq miles (2,040 sq km)
- 1.4 million
- Port Louis
- French Creole, others (+6)

The **picturesque island** of Mauritius in the **Indian Ocean** has more than 105 miles (170 km) of **spectacular coastline**. Volcanic **mountains** blanketed in **rain forest** rise up steeply in the center.



Underwater waterfall

Sand in shallow waters near the Le Morne peninsula is carried along by currents and dropped back down to the sea bed, creating an effect like a waterfall beneath the waves.



Award-winning architecture

Designed by the Mauritian architect Jean-Francois Koenig, the Mauritius Commercial Bank building in Port Louis has won awards for its unique design.

